

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS



OUR SOUTH ASIAN NEIGHBORS

MODULE – 4

POST NEHRU ERA

1 The 1962 war stressed upon the need to be pragmatic in Foreign policy considerations and this period symbolized Realism and Recovery.

2 PM Nehru had a tragic death after the 1962 war and was succeeded by Lal Bahadur Shastri.

3 Lack of experience in the domain of foreign affairs, PM Shastri announced in 1964 “Non-alignment will continue to be the fundamental of our approach to world problems and our relations with other countries.”

4 But the volatile situation in the immediate neighbourhood and domestic circumstances made him to concentrate on the South Asian neighbours.



CHINA'S NUCLEAR EXPLOSION 1964

1 India's insecurity towards China grew further when China successfully exploded an atom bomb in October 1964.

2 It tried to make a place in the world as a nuclear power. This also made China the fifth member in the nuclear club with USA, UK, USSR and France

3 It argued that for the protection of its people from US nuclear threat, it was compelled to conduct the nuclear test

4 But in the background of the Cold War following the principle of deterrence, China stood for nuclear disarmament and 'no first use' policy



DEBATES IN INDIA

This explosion in the neighbourhood pressurized PM Shastri to undertake a similar explosion in India

1

There was a debate on this issue with the following arguments

i

Supporters of the nuclear test were suspicious of China's activities and Homi Bhabha in 1960 had advised PM Nehru to produce quantities of plutonium for peaceful purposes. He said it could be beneficial to India's technological development as well.

ii

India could enhance its international reputation and regain its influence in Asia and Africa.

iii

India could show that it was not dependent on the United States militarily.



DEBATES IN INDIA

2 The government and the Indian National Congress are of the view including PM Shastri were opposed to the testing:

- i** India's domestic problems were more challenging than external problems and hence the focus needs to be on internal affairs. India's technological and industrial maturity did not support an explosion
- ii** A nuclear explosion would pressurize the Indian economy. Severe economic crisis and food crisis did not allow resources to be divested into military.
- iii** China had a favourable geographical condition as compared to India.
- iv** Nuclear explosion would counter India's consistent stand of using nuclear power for peaceful purposes.



INDIA'S RESPONSE

- 1 PM Shastri appealed to nations to censure China. "Anti Atomic Bomb Explosion Day" was organized by the Delhi Congress Committee with very less participation.
- 2 India defamed China for the atomic explosion and incited anti-Chinese feelings.
- 3 India wanted USA and USSR to disarm and prevent it from entering into the world nuclear club.
- 4 India also tried to portray that it had the capability of conducting the test but following its principles of peace and non-violence, it did not conduct a similar test.
- 5 India denied Ceylon's requests to declare the Indian Ocean a Nuclear Weapons Free Zone.



INDIA'S RESPONSE

6 In 1965, PM Shastri approved Dr Homi J Bhabha's suggestion. Accordingly, a plutonium reprocessing plant was started in India for the production of nuclear explosives.

7 This led to the launch of the Nuclear Explosive Design Group and the Study of Nuclear Explosions for Peaceful Purpose (SNEPP).

8 PM Shastri tried to respond to the changing situation.

9 Critics however point out that though India sensed a long term threat because of the explosion, it continued to focus on conventional rearmament, an acquisitions program being negotiated with the US, UK, and the Soviet Union, and the evolving border situation with Pakistan in 1965.



THE US ANGLE

- 1 During this time, USA was developing its relationship with Pakistan and did not support India to manufacture nuclear bombs.
- 2 However, suspicious of China's activities, the American Ambassador mentioned India could consider nuclear testing.
- 3 Since the 1950s, the United States helped India develop nuclear energy under the Atoms for Peace program. The United States built a nuclear reactor for India, provided nuclear fuel for a time, and allowed Indian scientists study at U.S. nuclear laboratories.
- 4 John F Kennedy had written to PM stating the importance of national security and the threats that China's security infrastructure can pose to India. He was aware of Nehru's views on nuclear testing.



THE US ANGLE

- 5 According to a report of ORF, if PM Nehru had accepted the US offer to detonating a nuclear bomb, joining the Security Council, the 1962 as well as the 1965 wars would have been avoided.
- 6 According to a recently published book JFK's Forgotten crisis, after the 1962 war, John F Kennedy planned to provide \$500 million military aid package to India for arms production and creation of mountain divisions.
- 7 But PM Nehru wanted an aid of \$1.3 billion to help India in its production facilities and prepare a UK-US air defense program for India.
- 8 But the US-Pakistan axis, Cold war calculations and statements on Kashmir influenced India's perception of the US.
- 9 US has considered Kashmir a disputed territory and stated that the issue should be resolved through negotiations between India and Pakistan and wishes of the people of Kashmir.



RELATIONS WITH SRI LANKA (CEYLON)

- 1 India's neighbor Sri Lanka was also under British colonial rule.
- 2 In 1833, the Colebrook reforms were introduced, which had transformed the socio-economic condition in Sri Lanka.
- 3 Under this system, Capitalist economy was set up and participation of private sector was encouraged.
- 4 Unused lands in large quantities were sold to private entrepreneurs and the British authorized commercial plantation on these lands
- 5 The local Sinhalese, however, did not want to work in these plantations.
- 6 So British brought workers from South India. These workers were proficient in cultivation of Tea and it provided for cheap labor for the British



WHEN DID THE ISSUE ARISE?

- 1 But the problem arose when Sri Lanka got independence in 1948. The question of citizenship of these plantation workers arose.
- 2 The Citizenship Act of 1949 took away the legal citizen statuses of the Indian workers.
- 3 But the disgruntlement of the Indian workers to this decision led the Sri Lankan PM Mrs Sirimavo Bandaranaike to visit India in 1964 and discuss the issue.
- 4 Upon discussions with PM Shastri, the Sirima-Shastri pact was signed on 30 October, 1964.



SIRIMA – SHASTRI PACT

The pact decided upon the following

- i The people of Indian origin, residing in Ceylon, who were not citizens of either India or Ceylon; were to become citizens of either India or Ceylon
- ii In this regard the Indian government would accept repatriations of persons within a period of 15 days of the signing of the pact.
- iii Moreover, Ceylon would allow those people who were employed during the signing of this pact to continue with their jobs until the date of their repatriation.



RELATIONS WITH BURMA

Not all countries after independence can sustain a democratic government like India. Burma, our neighbor is one such example.

- 1 Burma received independence in 1948. It established a democratic government.
- 2 But political and ethnic tensions started affecting the functioning of this democracy.
- 3 When the situation was out of control, the Prime Minister of Burma was forced to accept military rule to restore order in 1958.
- 4 The military exploited the weaknesses of the democratic government.

- 5 Under the military rule, Indians were discriminated by the people and oppressed by the government.



RELATIONS WITH BURMA

- 6 The military General Ne Win ordered Indians to be expelled from Burma
- 7 India made arrangements for transportation of Indians from Burma and arranged for their repatriation.
- 8 State governments in India were asked to provide adequate facilities for resettlement of these Indians.
- 9 In December 1965, PM Lal Bahadur Shastri made an official visit to Burma, and re-established cordial relations with the military government in Burma to safeguard India's interests.



1965 INDO – PAK WAR

- 1** Kashmir has always been a point for contention in India's domestic and foreign affairs, especially in Indo-Pak relations.
- 2** With the recent scrapping of Article 370, it has acquired new attention in bilateral relations
- 3** The 1965 war was hoped to resolve the dispute between neighbors and improve relations. It, however, further strained them.
- 4** The war began when Pakistan claimed half of the Kutch peninsular.
- 5** Pakistan took advantage of the fact that the border had been delineated, though not demarcated in the swampy region.



1965 INDO – PAK WAR

- 6 In 1965, Pakistan President Ayub Khan decided to begin insurrection in the Indian part of Kashmir leading to a war between India and Pakistan.
- 7 The objective was to annex Indian side of Kashmir or bring in international intervention.
- 8 Pakistan planned 'Operation Gibraltar' whereby warring units were created to train Kashmiri militants in the use of small arms.

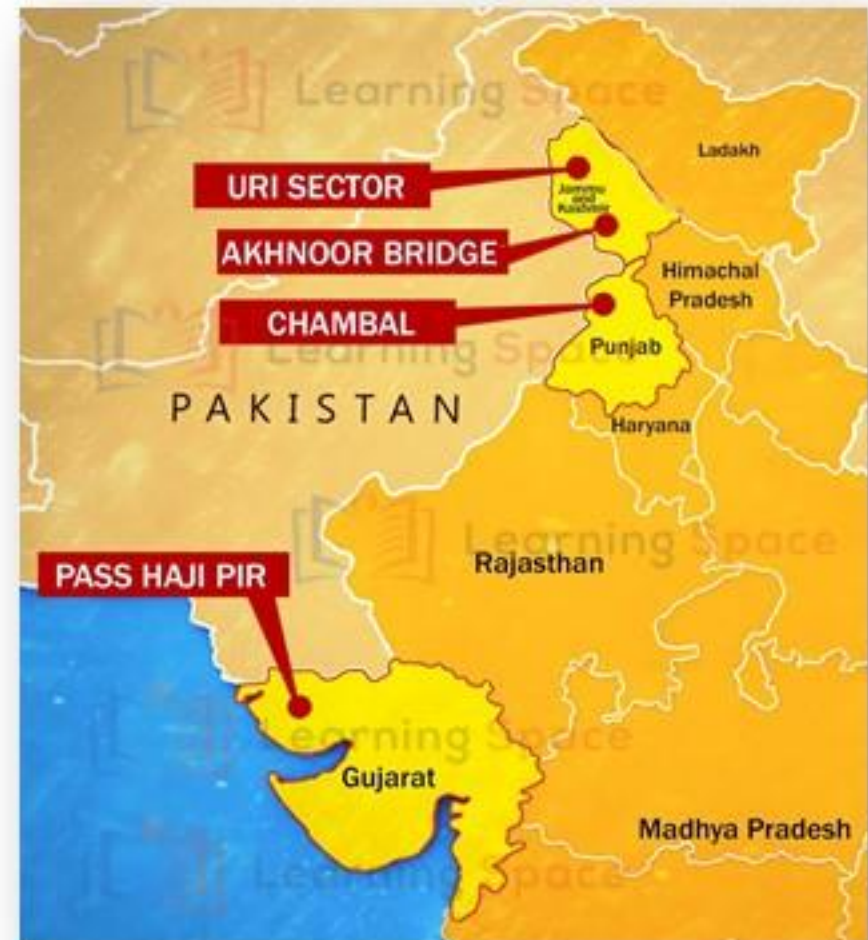


They attacked public property like bridges and government installations. The intention was to create confusion and spark unrest.

1965 INDO – PAK WAR

- 9** But when that was not very successful, Pakistan launched its reserve plan codenamed 'Operation Grand Slam' under which troops from Pakistan crossed the Jammu ceasefire line and entered Indian side using heavy artillery.
- 10** Indians fought back in the Uri sector and succeeded in capturing the pass of Haji Pir.
- 11** On 1 September, Pakistan launched an armed offensive in Chhambal where an infantry division with two regiments of American Patton tanks crossed the border and took the Indians by surprise.

The objective was to capture Akhnoor and sever the links between Jammu & Kashmir and Punjab



1965 INDO – PAK WAR

- 12** The battle took place in two fronts in the north-west- Kashmir and Punjab.
- 13** On 5th September, the Indian army was asked to attack from a new front.
- 14** On 6th several tank regiments crossed the border and reached Lahore.
- 15** Overhead, the aeroplanes destroyed the enemy's bases.
- 16** The Chinese supported the government of Pakistan and condemned the Indian actions and named them as Indian imperialism and that they pose a threat to South Asia.



ROLE OF PM SHASTRI

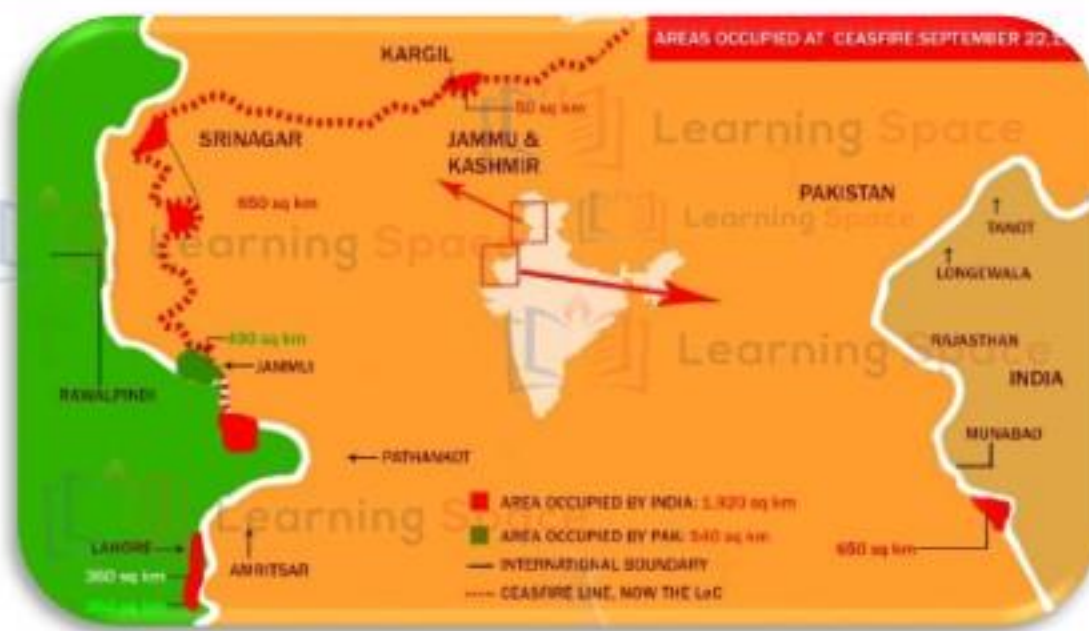
- 1** PM Shastri said that India had no intentions of causing trouble with its bordering neighbors, and that the country's focus of utilising its limited resources was for the economic progress.
- 2** But under the possibility of an incursion, the government would be quite clear in its objective of protecting the nation, and its duty in this regard would be wilfully and uncompromisingly discharged.
- 3** During the war, PM Shastri coined the slogan 'Jai Jawaan Jai Kisan' (Hail the Soldier, Hail the Farmer) in a bid to boost the morale of the Indian Army, and to encourage the farmers to do their best to increase food production of grains for reducing imports.



ROLE OF PM SHASTRI

- 4 The war with Pakistan went on for 5 months, between April and September of 1965.
- 5 Ultimately, on 23 September, 1965, UN declared a ceasefire ending the war between India and Pakistan.

In 1966, Soviet Union decided to mediate between India and Pakistan and PM Shastri and Ayyub Khan met in Tashkent and signed the agreement on 10th January 1966 to give away the conquered regions of each other by both parties, and return to the 1949 ceasefire line in Kashmir.



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